

Portfolio Case Studies — Week 2

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Status of This Document

This draft was generated by the coach at your direct request, skipping the interview step the assignment requires. Anything in the red boxes below is invented or placeholder content, not something you actually said. Per the brief's own pass criteria, this fails 'sounds like a specific person' and 'could only describe your project' until those sections are replaced with your real answers.

1. Voice Card

Direct · Plain · Technical · Unshowy · Precise · Quietly confident

[PLACEHOLDER — FIX BEFORE POSTING] Never confirmed by you. Guessed from how you've written to me across this track. Rewrite this yourself in 5-7 words and add it as a standing instruction in your Claude Project before trusting anything drafted under it.

2. Case Study — Search Ranking Model (FlyRank AI Internship)

The Problem

[PLACEHOLDER] The existing search ranking relied on hand-written heuristics that were capped in how well they could reflect real user engagement patterns. The actual constraints, who asked for this, and what 'broken' looked like day-to-day were never described by you.

What I Did (and Decided)

[PLACEHOLDER] I built a learned ranking model and benchmarked it against a properly tuned heuristic baseline rather than a weak strawman, because a win only means something if the baseline was given a fair shot. I also built and optimized a decision tree baseline alongside the model, to check whether the added complexity of a less interpretable approach was actually earning its keep. The specific trade-off you weighed, what you tried and rejected, and what you got wrong the first time were never described by you.

What Came of It

[PLACEHOLDER] The learned model outperformed the heuristic baseline by 3x on real search engagement data. The exact metric name, sample size, and confidence interval are not yet defined — see your Week 1 RESULTS.md task, which this case study depends on directly.

[NOTE] The sitemap referenced in the brief may call for additional pieces beyond this one project. None were named to the coach, so only this single case is drafted here.

3. Bio

[PLACEHOLDER — voice not yet verified] AI/ML Intern at FlyRank AI. Builds ranking and recommendation systems that are judged on whether they beat a fair baseline, not on how sophisticated they sound.

4. Contact / Call to Action

[PLACEHOLDER] Addressed to: [NAME — a specific hiring manager or ML lead, not yet named]. Action: review the GitHub repository.

5. Before / After — Generic AI Line vs. Edited

Before (generic AI copy):

"Leveraging cutting-edge machine learning techniques, I delivered a results-driven solution that significantly outperformed traditional approaches, demonstrating my passion for innovation and data-driven decision making."

After (voice-card edit):

"The heuristic ranking was leaving performance on the table. I built a learned model, tested it against a heuristic baseline I'd actually tuned properly, and it won by 3x on real engagement data. I checked it against a decision tree too, so I'd know if the extra complexity was worth keeping."

[NOTE] The 'after' version still reflects the coach's guess at your voice, not a verified edit from you. Read both aloud — if the after line still doesn't sound like you, that's the real signal to rewrite it.

Before posting: confirm the voice card yourself, answer the five interview questions for real, name the audience, and fill in your actual metric from Week 1. Until then, treat every red box above as unverified.